

JOHN PATTERSON

Patterson's Late Surge Tops the Field

A day that began with back-to-back quadruple bogeys ended with the best score of the round and an outright grip on the TEG 17 Trophy.

John Patterson opened round one of TEG 9 at Praia D'El Rey in the worst fashion available to him. Quadruple bogeys at the 1st and the 6th. An 8 on the card twice inside six holes. Two disasters that early would sink most rounds. Patterson steadied himself instead, and by the turn he was building something worthwhile.

The recovery began at the 12th. A birdie there broke a run of bogeys that had taken hold over a shaky 10th and 11th. From that point he barely put a foot wrong. He strung

pars together and stayed gross-shot clean from the 12th through the 16th, a stretch containing two separate two-hole spells without a shot dropped. The par at the 16th took him to the outright lead in the Trophy standings.

The finished round was 39 Stableford points, the best score of the day. The field's worst return was 32. Patterson had spent his opening six holes auditioning for that figure, then declined the part.

AT A GLANCE

ROUND OF THE DAY

John PATTERSON (39 pts)

TROPHY LEAD

John PATTERSON, 1 ahead

GREEN JACKET LEAD

Gregg WILLIAMS, 0 ahead

ROUND STABLEFORD

JP 39 | JB 38 | DM 33 | GW 33 | AB 32

ROUND GROSS

GW +20 | JB +20 | JP +23 | DM +24 | AB +41

AFTER R1 • TROPHY

JP 39 | JB 38 | DM 33 | GW 33 | AB 32

AFTER R1 • GREEN JACKET

GW +20 | JB +20 | JP +23 | DM +24 | AB +41

ALEX BAKER

Baker Rewrites the Record Books, Badly

Five ruinous holes and a closing quintuple bogey leave the course record broken for all the wrong reasons.

Alex Baker set a new course-worst at Praia D'El Rey in the opening round of TEG 16. A gross 114. The previous worst was 110, a mark that had survived 24 prior visits to the course. It was Baker's fifth visit. His previous best there was 100, meaning he found 14 strokes more than the last time he played it.

The bulk of the work was done between the 3rd and the 5th, where he dropped 13 shots and failed to record a single net par. The 5th is stroke index 2, one of the hardest holes on the course. It returned a sextuple-bogey 10. The 4th had already contributed a quadruple-bogey 8. He then closed with a quintuple-bogey 9 at the 18th, which had

the air of a man signing his own work. Three holes accounted for 27 shots. The round stands as the highest gross score ever recorded at Praia D'El Rey.

SIDEBAR

Jacket Shared, Spoon Already Anchored

One round in, the Green Jacket is already a two-way tie and the Wooden Spoon has found its first occupant.

Round one at Praia D'El Rey took its time settling. Jon Baker moved first, taking the outright TEG Trophy lead with a par at the 3rd. Holding the lead at the 3rd hole of a tournament is an honour of limited shelf life. John Patterson claimed it for keeps at the 16th and held it to the close. Patterson's round leaves him level with the field on Stableford at the top, with his best gross at the course now standing at 96.

In the TEG Green Jacket, Gregg Williams drew level for the lead with a par at the par-5 17th, the hardest hole on the course. He finished the day out in front. His 93 matches his best gross score around this course, which is either consistency or a ceiling.

At the other end of the field, Alex Baker's day ended as it had largely proceeded. The quintuple bogey at the 18th dropped him to the bottom of the Wooden Spoon standings after one round. He had spent the afternoon building the plinth. He simply stepped onto it.

DAVID MULLIN

Mullin's Round of Two Halves

A front nine that threatened to unravel gave way to the best stretch of anyone's day.

David Mullin's opening round at Praia D'El Rey came in two clearly separated halves. The 4th was a double bogey. So were the 5th, the 6th and the 7th. The 8th, a par 3, took a triple. Eleven shots gone in five holes, delivered with the steadiness of a man clocking in for a shift. Three of those holes, from the 6th to the 8th, passed without a single net par.

The back nine reversed everything. From the 9th he found pars on two holes without dropping a shot. He then ran off three unblemished holes from the 12th to the 14th, capped by a birdie at the 13th. The form held to the 16th, and the stretch from the 12th was worth 16 Stableford points. The round finished on 33 points. It was 13 points stronger on the back nine than the front, which is less a round of golf than two men sharing a card. It also left him well short of his best gross at the course, eight shots worse than his last visit here.

RECORDS & PERSONAL BESTS

Notable achievements: TEG 17, Round 1

PERSONAL WORSTS

— David Mullin — +18 Gross on the Front nine is a personal-worst Front nine Gross

— David Mullin — 10 Stableford on the Front nine is a personal-worst Front nine Stableford